GEOFFROY'S SPIDER MONKEY

Ateles geoffroyi

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
Forward-facing eyes judge jumps, sharp ears catch faraway calls, and its nose checks if fruit is ripe.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives in the tops of huge rainforest trees, where many fruit trees must share one home.

3. How does it send messages?
It barks to warn of predators, whinnies to stay in touch, and shakes branches when threatened.

4. What does it do when something changes?
When danger comes, it climbs higher fast, and the group splits up to find food safely.

5. How does it learn?
Babies cling to their mother for more than a year and watch adults to learn safe fruiting trees.

6. How does it have babies?
A mother has one baby every two or three years and carries it close for the first months.

7. What are its limits?
It needs huge, unbroken rainforests, so cutting the trees into small pieces starves the group.

8. What does this teach us?
Spread out to find food, gather again to rest — the group's shape follows the forest.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Spider monkeys live high in the rainforest canopy of Central America.

Their forests are being cut for farmland, cattle, and timber.

They need tall, connected trees to swing and feed across huge areas.

When its habitat shrinks:

- gaps in the canopy cut families off from food
- slow breeding means lost groups are hard to replace
- they are listed as endangered across most of their range

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If your tail worked like an extra hand, what would you pick up first?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

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